

Auwa Structure

Last Updated: 20 July 2026

This file is the single reference for Auwa's corporate structure, intellectual property, trademarks, licensing, domains, and social accounts. Original documents are stored in `Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/`.

CORPORATE ENTITIES

Auwa Limited (IP Holding Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	17033727
Incorporated	15 February 2026
Status	Dormant (holds IP assets only)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining
Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Registered Address	167-169 Great Portland Street, Fifth Floor, London, England, W1W 5PF
Companies House	View

Auwa Limited owns all Auwa intellectual property and licenses it to More Air Limited for development and operations. Owning IP does not trigger "active" status. File dormant accounts annually (free, 5 minutes).

Activation triggers: Revenue exceeding ~£100k/year, outside investment, major B2B deal, or team expansion. On activation: license novates from More Air to Auwa Limited, domains/handles transfer, More Air becomes development partner.

More Air Limited (Operating Company)

Field	Detail
Company No.	7051794
Incorporated	2009
Status	Active (trading)
Directors	Rieko Vining, Thomas Vining
Shareholders	Rieko Vining (50%), Thomas Vining (50%)
Website	moreair.co

More Air handles all Auwa commercial activity: website, app, store, marketing, revenue, and expenses. Auwa is operated under an exclusive worldwide license from Auwa Limited.

How Money Flows

More Air client work funds the founders separately. All Auwa revenue is received by More Air Limited and reinvested into growth. Auwa Limited receives no revenue while dormant.

Confirmed 12 August 2026: this is a deliberate choice, not a temporary arrangement. Income flows to More Air because it is the core business, running two active companies is more hassle, and More Air holds carry-forward Corporation Tax savings. Auwa Limited gets switched on later when it scales.

Two consequences worth holding on to. A publishing contract should be with More Air, not Auwa Limited, because an advance paid to Auwa Ltd would end its dormancy. And More Air must be **VAT registered** for all Auwa sales, so VAT applies from the first one: 20% on figures, prints and paper goods, zero on printed books, zero on exports outside the UK. Prices are set VAT-inclusive.

*Correction, 12 Aug 2026: this section previously said the future royalty would run "from More Air to Tom + Rieko personally." The signed licence at clause 3.3, as varied, points royalties at **Auwa Limited**, not at the shareholders personally. Those are materially different tax paths. The signed document governs; the note here was wrong.*

More Air pays Auwa-related expenses (trademark filings, domains, hosting) and records these as operational costs.

TEAM

Following the traditional Japanese ukiyo-e model: eshi (artist) + hanmoto (publisher) as equal partnership.

Rieko Maeda, Creator (Eshi): Japanese-born illustrator from Kansai, also known by her artist name Eko. Creator of the Auwa universe (2015 onwards). Native Japanese speaker. 20+ years design and illustration. Leads: character art, seasonal content, figure design, creative direction, Japanese craftsman outreach. (Legal name: Rieko Vining.)

Thomas Vining, Producer (Hanmoto): Design technologist and brand strategist. 20+ years experience (Nokia, Apple, Sky). Built and operated a Japanese multi-merchant platform (2005-2007). Leads: app design and build, brand, business development, marketing, project oversight, store platform and operations.

Capacity: Tuesday to Friday (3-4 day week, 10am-6pm). Auwa gets 60%, More Air 25%, ventures 10%. No work Monday. Health and relationship come before any deadline.

OWNERSHIP CHAIN (IP)

1. Rieko + Tom created all Auwa IP (artwork, stories, name, character) from ~2015 onwards
 2. IP assigned from personal names to Auwa Limited via Assignment Agreement (23 February 2026)
 3. Auwa Limited licenses IP to More Air Limited for development/operations
 4. More Air handles all commercial activity (website, app, store, marketing)
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TRADEMARKS

Word Mark: "Auwa" — Batch 1

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004341028
Filed	15 February 2026

Registry	UK IPO
Classes	9, 16, 20, 41
Priority Date	15 February 2026
Cost	£320
Status	REGISTERED (15 May 2026, no opposition)
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 1/

Nice Classification:

- **Class 9:** Software, mobile apps, downloadable content
- **Class 16:** Books, printed matter, illustrations
- **Class 20:** Decorative objects, figurines (non-toy)
- **Class 41:** Entertainment, exhibitions, publishing, music services

Expected registration: ~May 2026 (2 months from advertisement date, if no opposition).

Word Mark: "Auwa" — Batch 2

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa (word mark)
Application No.	UK00004373944
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	25, 28, 35
Cost	£325
Status	Pending (per WIPO Global Brand Database, July 2026)
Owner	Auwa Limited
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/application/batch 2/

Nice Classification (exact register wording, verified against WIPO Global Brand Database 20 Jul 2026):

- **Class 25:** clothing, footwear, headwear; t-shirts; sweatshirts; hoodies; sweaters; jackets; tops; printed t-shirts; graphic t-shirts; casual clothing; loungewear; sleepwear; scarves; hats; caps; beanies; socks; clothing featuring artistic illustrations and seasonal designs
- **Class 28:** toys, games, and playthings; collectible toys; collectible figures; collectible figurines; vinyl toys; designer toys; art toys; display figurines; decorative toy figures; limited edition collectible figures; blind box toys; character toys; ornamental toy figures; miniature figurines; toy figures featuring illustrated characters
- **Class 35:** online retail store services relating to wellness software, mobile applications, downloadable digital content, books, illustrated books, printed publications, art prints, posters, calendars, notebooks, stationery, greeting cards, figurines, works of art, ornaments, collectible toys, collectible figures, vinyl toys, designer toys, art toys, clothing, t-shirts, sweatshirts, hoodies, sweaters, jackets, hats, caps, scarves, socks

(Note: "decorative objects" is in Class 20 of the Batch 1 word mark and in the design mark, NOT in Class 35.)

Combined word mark coverage: Batch 1 + Batch 2 gives Auwa word mark protection across **7 classes** (9, 16, 20, 25, 28, 35, 41) in the UK.

TM3A Amendment — DECLINED

An attempt to add Classes 25, 28, 35 via TM3A form (~23 February 2026, £150) was declined. TM3A only allows transfer of goods between existing classes, not addition of new classes. Fee refunded. This led to the Batch 2 filing above.

Ownership Transfer (TM16)

Field	Detail
Form	TM16
Transfer	From Thomas Vining + Rieko Vining to Auwa Limited
Filed	~24 February 2026
Cost	£50
Status	Confirmed (26 February 2026)

Documents	trademark/2 word mark/ownership/
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Design Mark: Auwa Character

Field	Detail
Mark	Auwa character silhouette (full, with arms)
Application No.	UK00004373930
Filed	16 April 2026
Registry	UK IPO
Classes	20 (decorative objects), 28 (toys)
Cost	£265
Invoice No.	1026117494
Payment Ref	L8PTTUYSY
Owner	Auwa Limited
Status	Published 3 July 2026 (journal 2026/027); opposition period runs to ~3 September 2026
Image Format	Black silhouette on white background
Artwork	trademark/3 design mark/artwork/auwa.ai and auwa.png
Documents	trademark/3 design mark/application/01-*.pdf

Filed as standard black-on-white (not colour-specific) following the KAWS precedent, allowing enforcement in any colour variant. Single application for the full character with arms. Simplified "without arms" version deferred unless needed later.

Evidence (Character Creation Dates)

Evidence supporting Rieko's creation of the Auwa character from 2015 onwards, stored in trademark/3 design mark/evidence/ :

- **artwork/files/** — Original Illustrator files dated 2016-2020

- **artwork/screenshots/** — File property screenshots showing creation dates
- **linkedin/20170710/** — LinkedIn posts from July 2017 showing Auwa character publicly shared
- **gemini/** — Screenshots from AI chat proving character discussion predates filings

Trademark Searches

WIPO Global Brand Database: Clean. No conflicting marks in Auwa's target classes. **Google Image Search:** No conflicting character designs found. **UK IPO:** Keyword search for "Auwa" returned zero results in relevant classes. Screenshots saved in `trademark/3 design mark/search/`.

PROTECTION RATIONALE — why these classes and territories

The single principle: **a trademark protects the *name* "Auwa" and the *character shape*, not the products**. Copying the actual artwork or figure is stopped by copyright (Rieko's dated originals) and the design mark. Each class stakes the name in a category of commerce tied to a real Auwa product or pillar, so this is the answer to any future "why did we pay for this class" question.

Word mark classes

Class	Protects the name "Auwa" on...	Auwa product / pillar
9	downloadable software, the app, digital content and publications	Kokoro Mirror app (as a downloadable product)
16	printed and illustrated books, art prints, stationery, cards	Rieko's illustrated books and prints (Book pillar / store)
20	decorative objects, figurines, ornaments (non-toy)	the Auwa figure as a decorative object; craft objects
25	clothing, headwear, apparel	merch / print-on-demand apparel (planned, plausible within 5 yrs)

28	toys, collectible and art figures, character toys	the collectible Auwa figure — the flagship physical product
35	online retail store services	the Auwa store as a named business, especially the Year 2 craftsman marketplace (selling third-party goods under the Auwa banner)
41	entertainment/education services, online experiences, publishing, exhibitions, interactive stories	the app <i>experience</i> , the Journal, the Book universe as experiences, exhibitions

9 and 41 deliberately overlap: the app is both a downloadable product (9) and an online service/experience (41), and an examiner or opponent could characterise it either way, so both flanks are covered. 41 also carries the Journal, the exhibition strategy, and the story-experiences, which are services, not downloadable goods.

Why 35 is worth having (the least obvious class): it protects "Auwa" as the *name of a shop/retail service*, independent of the goods. The goods classes stop someone selling Auwa-branded books or figures; class 35 stops someone opening an online store *called* "Auwa" selling their own unrelated products on our goodwill, and it is the class that covers selling *other people's* craftsman goods under the Auwa banner (the Year 2 marketplace line in the business plan). Quieter than 9/28/41, but coherent.

Design mark (the character silhouette) — classes 20 + 28

Protects the character *shape* as a brand identifier: stops a copycat selling a confusingly similar Auwa-like figurine (20) or collectible toy (28). This is the tier-one, hardest-to-replace asset in the value hierarchy.

Territories

Territory	Why
UK	Home; the base registrations everything else rests on
EU	Largest UK-adjacent consumer market; where early European sales and press land

US	Biggest market on earth for collectibles, illustrated books and app spend; DTC online sales reach US collectors; high-counterfeit market where enforcement matters. (Ranked #2 in the 8 Jul plan's own trim priority: JP > US > EU.)
Japan	Cultural home of the philosophy and Rieko's origin; a real target market and a source of cultural validation
China	Defensive only: anti-squat / anti-counterfeit for character IP in a first-to-file country, where curing a squat later is slow and costly. Cheap insurance (~£1,080 across both marks). Figures are self-produced at home, so China is not a manufacturing dependency.

Copyright (Rieko's dated original artwork, automatic under the Berne Convention across all five territories) protects the artwork itself; the trademarks protect the *name* and *character shape* as brand identifiers. Complementary layers: copyright stops reproduction of the art, trademark stops commercial use of the brand.

INTERNATIONAL FILING (Madrid Protocol)

DECISION MADE (15 July 2026): file comprehensively now, both marks, four core markets. Tom and Rieko chose the full-perimeter option over the earlier lean/deferred plan. Rationale: the capital cost is negligible against net worth and the risk of a first-to-file squatter (especially in China, the likely manufacturing base for the figure) is real once the character and name are public. Auwa is a product ecosystem, not an anonymous artist moniker, so the norm is to protect *before* launch. This also buys total mental clarity — no multi-year WIPO calendar dictating attention. The earlier "word mark only / design deferred to Year 2 / £650-1,050" plan is **retired**.

What is being filed

Mark	Classes	Territories	WIPO fee
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Word mark ("Auwa")	9, 16, 20, 25, 28, 35, 41 (all 7 UK classes; JP excludes 25)	JP, US, EU, CN	CHF 7,571
Design mark (figure silhouette)	20, 28	JP, US, EU, CN	CHF 3,169
		Total	CHF 10,740 (~£9,600) + 2× £50 IPO handling

These are **two separate international applications** (different marks = different international registrations, each its own MM2 and basic fee). Word mark rests on the UK bases: Batch 1 (registered, classes 9/16/20/41) + Batch 2 (pending, classes 25/28/35). Design mark rests on the UK design mark (published, pending registration).

Fees are the WIPO Fee Calculator figures of 20 Jul 2026 (mark black & white, office of origin UK). Breakdown per mark: basic 653 CHF + individual fees per party (no complementary/supplementary — all four are individual-fee jurisdictions). Word mark: JP **1,261 (6 classes — class 25 dropped from Japan)** + US 3,220 + EU 1,557 + CN 880. Design mark: JP 429 + US 920 + EU 837 + CN 330. The word-mark fee summary PDF in the folder still shows the 7-class Japan figure (7,779); the amount to pay is **7,571. Re-run the calculator immediately before paying** in case the fee schedule changes.

Applications FILED (20 Jul 2026)

Both international applications **emailed to internationaltrademarks@ipo.gov.uk on 20 Jul 2026** (two separate emails, each with MM2 + continuation sheet + MM18). Signed by Thomas Vining (Director) and dated 20/07/2026. £50 IPO handling fee paid online per mark, from More Air:

- Word mark — FS4 payment reference **HJ74X644X6**
- Design mark — FS4 payment reference **KUVHCCJHVR**

Source forms stored in `trademark/4 global expansion/application/`. WIPO fees (CHF 7,571 word / CHF 3,169 design) still to be paid to WIPO directly once billed after certification. **Now awaiting IPO certification** (payment receipt ~5 days; certification or deficiency notice within ~15 working days), then onward transmission to WIPO.

What happens next (post-filing)

1. **UK IPO** certifies the applications match the UK basic marks and forwards to WIPO. If any deficiency, they email; respond and resend.
2. **WIPO** examines formalities. Possible "irregularity" notices (classification, fees) — fixable. Then records the International Registration, assigns an IR number, publishes in the WIPO Gazette, notifies each designated office, and bills the CHF fees.
3. **Each designated office (JP, US, EU, CN)** examines under its own law within the Madrid deadline (12 or 18 months). Each either grants protection or issues a **provisional refusal** (relative grounds = conflicting mark, or absolute = descriptiveness, or a query on the goods wording). Most likely touch-points: **US** (USPTO tends to query goods/services specificity), **EU** (a 3-month third-party opposition window after publication), **China** (relative-grounds check). Japan class 25 was dropped, so no Juno refusal expected.
4. **Responding to a provisional refusal usually requires a LOCAL attorney** in that country (national offices require a local address for service; WIPO cannot represent you). Budget for this only if a refusal actually lands. Claude can help triage/strategise, but the formal response is filed by local counsel.
5. No refusal within the deadline = automatic **statement of grant of protection**. Full process typically 12–18 months per territory; the IR itself is recorded within a few weeks.

Payment routing (preserves Auwa Ltd dormancy)

More Air Limited pays WIPO directly. Do NOT route through Auwa Limited — a payment or cross-charge would end its dormant status and trigger tax filings. Because More Air is the exclusive licensee trading on the IP, the trademark cost is "wholly and exclusively" for More Air's trade and is an allowable Corporation Tax deduction. Set up the WIPO account in More Air's name, pay from a More Air card/account, save the receipt alongside the licence agreement. Do NOT let More Air invoice Auwa Ltd for it. True net personal cost after CT relief and dividend-tax-avoided is roughly £5,200-7,300 depending on marginal rate.

Priority deadlines (the only hard clocks)

- **15 Aug 2026** — word mark classes 9, 16, 20, 41 (Batch 1 priority, 15 Feb). File the whole word-mark MM2 by this date; a single application can carry multiple priority claims, so classes 25/28/35 (Batch 2 priority, 16 Apr, live until 16 Oct) can ride in the same filing.
- **16 Oct 2026** — design mark (filed 16 Apr) and word-mark classes 25/28/35 if for any reason they're split into a later filing.

Sequencing plan — RESOLVED

Tom asked **Laura McLoughlin** (UK IPO) whether the two pending marks (Batch 2 word mark, design mark) could be registered before the Madrid filing. Reply (15 Jul 2026): they are in the publication phase, opposition period ends **3 Sep 2026**, and if unopposed they register ~~2 weeks later~~ (**17 Sep 2026**); the timeline is a legal requirement and cannot be accelerated. Decision: filed anyway on 20 Jul (word mark had a hard 15 Aug priority deadline regardless). The two pending bases therefore carry the 5-year "central attack" dependency until they register — low risk given no opposition flagged, with paid "transformation" into national filings as a safety valve if a base ever failed.

Known conflict to handle: Japan class 25 — DECISION: drop from Japan

Juno International holds "Auwa" in Japan including **class 25** (clothing). Japan examines earlier rights on its own initiative, so a class-25 designation there would be refused (senior identical mark). **Decision (20 Jul 2026): drop class 25 from the Japan designation.** Done on the word-mark MM2 via an item 10(b) limitation: "The designation of Japan is limited to Classes 9, 16, 20, 28, 35 and 41. Protection is NOT sought in Japan for Class 25." This lowers Japan's individual fee from CHF 1,469 (7 classes) to **CHF 1,261 (6 classes)**, saving ~£185; the word-mark total drops to CHF 7,571. No separate communication to WIPO/IPO is needed — the limitation is a standard MM2 field the IPO certifies and WIPO records. The WIPO fee calculator can't isolate one class per country in a combined run, so the fee summary PDF still shows 7 classes; Japan's 6-class fee (1,261) is confirmed by the per-class fee structure and can be re-verified via a Japan-only 6-class calculator run. All other filed classes are clear in Japan (Juno's 3/10/14/18 don't overlap).

Later relocation to Japan (noted, not yet planned)

If Tom and Rieko permanently relocate and move the brand to a Japanese Auwa entity, the international registration can be reassigned to the new owner for a small administrative WIPO fee (per Gemini). Not a near-term action; recorded so the option is known.

Adding territories later (if ever)

Subsequent designation (form MM4) extends the existing international registration to a new country for ~CHF 300 base + that country's individual fee. So Korea, Indonesia, etc. (the wider KAWS-style perimeter) can be added cheaply later if manufacturing or counterfeit activity ever justifies it. No need to over-file now beyond the four core markets.

Japan: Juno International Conflict

Field	Detail
Existing Mark	"Auwa" registered in Japan by Juno International
Japan Application No.	第6712100号
Juno's Classes	3 (cosmetics), 10 (medical), 14 (jewellery), 18 (leather goods), 25 (clothing)
Overlap with Auwa	None in core classes
Documents	trademark/2 word mark/exclusions/juno- international.txt

Safe in Japan: App, books, figurines, wooden objects, digital experiences, entertainment, toys/collectibles. **Blocked in Japan:** Class 25 (clothing) — Juno's class. **Decision is to drop class 25 from the Japan Madrid designation** (item 10(b) limitation on the word-mark MM2), saving ~£185 (see "Known conflict to handle: Japan class 25" above). **Options (deferred):** Contact Juno, challenge for non-use, or negotiate. Japanese IP lawyer ~£1,500-2,000.

Other Conflicts

WashTec (industrial cleaning) owns "Auwa" in their industry. Zero class overlap. Risk of challenge: 5-10%. **Sony** had an expired Class 9 filing (expired 2017). No longer relevant.

COPYRIGHT

Rieko's artwork is automatically protected from moment of creation under the Berne Convention (UK, EU, USA, Japan). No registration required.

Evidence: Illustrator files from 2016 onwards, LinkedIn posts from July 2017, 4 completed illustrated books, Dropbox files with modification dates.

Formal registration (not pursued): UK IPO £30, US Copyright Office \$65, Chinese registration £100-200. All deferred given the volume of dated evidence already held.

Copyright protects the specific artwork (stops exact copying). Trademark (design mark) protects the character shape as brand identifier (stops commercial use of similar shapes). Both needed for

full protection.

LICENSING AGREEMENTS

IP Assignment: Personal to Auwa Limited (Active)

Field	Detail
Date	23 February 2026
Assignors	Rieko Vining + Thomas Vining
Assignee	Auwa Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Consideration	£1 nominal
Covers	UK Trademark UK00004341028, all copyright in Auwa character/illustrations/books/stories, all future IP rights
Document	trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_assignment. pdf

Operating License: Auwa Limited to More Air (Active)

Field	Detail
Date	23 February 2026
Licensor	Auwa Limited (Company No. 17033727)
Licensee	More Air Limited (Company No. 7051794)
Grant	Exclusive, worldwide license to use, develop, and commercialise Auwa character, trademarks, and associated IP
Sublicensing	Express right added by the 12 Aug 2026 variation (was silent, which was a real gap)
Consideration	£1 nominal (royalty-free for now)

Termination	Runs to 31 Dec 2036, then rolling; see variation below (was 30 days' notice by either party)
Historical clause	Acknowledges More Air's development since 2017 under verbal agreement
Document	trademark/1 license/20260223_auwa_license.pdf f

Licence Variation (Active — signed 12 August 2026)

Reviewed on 12 Aug 2026 against what More Air is about to do with the licence: sell physical goods through Shopify, sign a publishing contract, and enter collaboration agreements where a Japanese maker manufactures and sells Auwa-formed goods. Three gaps found and closed.

Field	Detail
Date	12 August 2026
Document	trademark/1 license/20260812_auwa_license_variation.pdf (+ .docx)
Varies	The 23 Feb 2026 Operating Licence. Read as one document with it.

What changed and why:

- Express sub-licensing right, with survival on termination.** The original was silent on sub-licensing, and More Air is about to grant rights onward to a publisher, to manufacturers and to collaborating artists and craftspeople. Sub-licences granted in good faith survive termination of the head licence, with Auwa Limited substituted as grantor. A publisher's contracts team checks exactly this.
- Term extended to 31 Dec 2036**, then rolling year to year on twelve months' notice. Before then, terminable only for unremedied material breach, insolvency, or by written agreement of both parties. **Thirty days' notice was too short to survive publisher due diligence** on a contract that runs for years.
- Explicit novation clause (2.4).** The parties may terminate, novate, assign or restructure at any time by written agreement, including so that Auwa Limited operates the

business directly. This deliberately preserves the activation path described at the top of this document; the ten-year term blocks only *unilateral* termination, and Tom is a director of both parties, so mutual termination is always available.

4. **Scope confirmed** to cover all Auwa IP owned from time to time, including marks applied for or registered after Feb 2026.
5. **Clause 3.3 rewritten.** All revenue belongs to More Air, which bears the costs and risks. No royalty is payable while Auwa Limited is dormant. If it ceases to be dormant, the parties negotiate in good faith, but the clause records an intention to negotiate and creates no binding obligation to agree.

Moral Rights Assertion (Active — signed 12 August 2026)

Field	Detail
Date	12 August 2026
Parties	Rieko Vining (Author) + Auwa Limited
Document	trademark/1 license/20260812_auwa_moral_rights.pdf (+ .docx)

The Feb 2026 assignment transferred copyright but said nothing about moral rights. Under s.78 of the Copyright, Designs and Patents Act 1988 the **right to be identified as author only takes effect if asserted in writing**, so the house rule "always credit Rieko as creator" had no legal footing until now. The assertion covers all media and territories, sets the credit as "Eko Maeda" on published books and "Rieko Maeda" elsewhere, obliges Auwa Limited to procure observance by any licensee, sub-licensee, publisher, manufacturer or collaborator, and does not waive her s.80 right to object to derogatory treatment.

Trademark ownership verified 12 Aug 2026: the UKIPO register shows Auwa Limited as owner of all three UK marks — UK00004341028 (registered 15 May 2026, classes 9/16/20/41), UK00004373930 (pending, classes 20/28) and UK00004373944 (pending, classes 25/28/35).

Outstanding admin: a short written resolution in each company's records noting the directors approved the variation, since Thomas Vining signs for both parties and that is a declarable interest under the Companies Act 2006.

Original License (Superseded)

The first license (14 February 2026, personal to More Air) is superseded by the structure above.
Archived in `trademark/1 license/_archive/`.

DOMAINS

Domain	Purpose
auwa.life	Primary (brand home, website)
auwalife.com	Redirect to auwa.life
auwa.app	App (Kokoro Mirror)
auwaapp.com	Redirect to auwa.app
auwa.world	Story/brand universe
auwaworld.com	Redirect
auwa.store	Shop
auwastore.com	Redirect
auwa.co.uk	UK legal protection
auwa.uk	UK legal protection

Registrar: UK2.net (consistent with More Air domains). **Email:** hello@auwa.life (configured), plus platform-specific aliases. **Not available:** auwa.art. **Pre-existing:** auwaworld.com (registered ~2017).

SOCIAL HANDLES

See `context/marketing/social.md` for the full, current social account map (handles, logins, status, pending verifications, and outstanding steps). `social.md` is the single source of truth and is updated whenever the social landscape changes.

Summary: one brand, three handle variants by necessity. `@auwalife` is the default, `@auwa.life` is used on TikTok and Bluesky (where dots are permitted and match the domain), `@auwa` on LinkedIn (pure brand name, pre-owned). All accounts route to `social@auwa.life`.

COSTS SUMMARY

Item	Cost	Status
Word mark Batch 1 (Classes 9, 16, 20, 41)	£320	Paid
TM3A amendment (declined)	£150	Paid (refunded)
TM16 ownership transfer	£50	Paid
Auwa Limited incorporation	~£50	Done
Domains (~11)	~£51	Secured
Word mark Batch 2 (Classes 25, 28, 35)	£325	Paid
Design mark UK (Classes 20, 28)	£265	Paid
Total spent	~£1,061	
Madrid word mark (7 classes × US/EU/CN; JP 6 classes)	CHF 7,571	Forms prepared 20 Jul; pay via More Air
Madrid design mark (2 classes × JP/US/EU/CN)	CHF 3,169	Forms prepared 20 Jul; pay via More Air
Madrid IPO handling (2× £50)	£100	Pay via More Air
Madrid total	CHF 10,740 (~£9,600) + £100	Re-run calculator before paying
Estimated total IP spend	~£10,800	

KEY DATES & DEADLINES

Date	Event
15 Feb 2026	Auwa Limited incorporated. Word mark Batch 1 filed (UK00004341028)

23 Feb 2026	IP assignment + license agreements signed
24 Feb 2026	TM16 ownership transfer filed
26 Feb 2026	TM16 confirmed
27 Feb 2026	Word mark Batch 1 examination complete
6 Mar 2026	Word mark Batch 1 enters advertisement (opposition) period
16 Apr 2026	Design mark filed (UK00004373930), Classes 20 + 28
16 Apr 2026	Word mark Batch 2 filed (UK00004373944), Classes 25, 28, 35
15 May 2026	Word mark Batch 1 REGISTERED (UK00004341028)
3 Jul 2026	Design mark published for opposition (journal 2026/027); window ends ~3 Sep 2026
15 Jul 2026	Decision to file Madrid comprehensively; McLoughlin confirms pending marks can't be expedited
20 Jul 2026	Madrid applications FILED — word mark + design mark, JP/US/EU/CN, emailed to IPO
~5 days after	IPO payment receipt expected
~15 working days after	IPO certification (or deficiency notice) expected
~3 Sep 2026	UK opposition window ends for Batch 2 word mark + design mark
~17 Sep 2026	Batch 2 word mark + design mark expected to REGISTER (if unopposed)
(12–18 months)	Designated offices (JP/US/EU/CN) grant protection or issue provisional refusals

OPEN ACTIONS

1. **Design mark filing — DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373930. Classes 20 + 28. £265.
 2. **Word mark additional classes — DONE.** 16 April 2026. UK00004373944. Classes 25, 28, 35. £325.
 3. **Madrid Protocol filing — FILED 20 Jul 2026.** Both MM2s (+ FS4, continuation, MM18) emailed to the IPO. Word mark CHF 7,571 (JP class 25 dropped), design mark CHF 3,169, both JP/US/EU/CN. £50 handling fee paid per mark (refs HJ74X644X6 word / KUVHCCJHVR design). **Now open:** (a) watch for IPO payment receipt (~~5 days~~) and certification (15 working days); (b) **pay WIPO the CHF fees** when billed, from More Air; (c) respond to any WIPO irregularity; (d) later, respond to any provisional refusals from JP/US/EU/CN (likely needs local counsel — flag to Claude). See "What happens next" under INTERNATIONAL FILING.
 4. **Word mark Batch 1 opposition period — DONE.** Registered 15 May 2026, no opposition. 4b. **Design mark opposition window** — published 3 July 2026; monitor until ~3 September 2026. UKIPO notifies if opposed; no action otherwise. 4c. **Batch 2 registration** — still pending; monitor (part of the McLoughlin expedite ask). Rides in the Madrid filing on the pending application until registered (central-attack dependency until then).
 5. **Royalty structure** — Not triggered while Auwa Limited is dormant, and the 12 Aug 2026 variation makes that explicit. Revisit only on activation. Accountant review needed then, not now. 5b. **Board minutes for the 12 Aug variation** — a written resolution in each company's records, since Thomas Vining signs both sides. Two paragraphs, not yet done. 5c. **EU / IOSS decision** — selling physical goods into the EU under €150 needs either an IOSS registration (a UK seller needs an EU intermediary post-Brexit) or the customer pays VAT plus a courier handling fee on delivery. Decide before the figure drop whether the EU is in scope at launch or whether phase 1 is UK plus US only. 5d. **Class 39 (travel services)** — not covered by the current portfolio. Only relevant if "Auwa Journeys" becomes a named commercial product. Do not disturb the Madrid filing over it.
 6. **Social handle registration** — Secure across remaining platforms (see handles table above).
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LEGAL PRINCIPLES (Reference)

- **No attorney hired.** All filings done DIY to date.
- **Personal ownership = personal liability.** Corrected by assigning IP to Auwa Limited.
- **Use in commerce requirement:** Must actually use trademark in each registered class within 5 years or risk cancellation for non-use.

- **Paris Convention:** First filing gives 6 months to file in other jurisdictions with the same priority date (15 Feb 2026).
- **Nominal consideration (£1):** Makes agreements legally binding under English contract law.
- **Standard black-on-white design marks** allow enforcement in any colour (KAWS precedent).

KEY CONTACTS

	Detail
Tom Vining, Producer	tom@moreair.co
Rieko Maeda, Creator	rieiko@moreair.co
Auwa	hello@auwa.life
More Air	moreair.co
Companies House	Auwa Ltd 17033727, More Air Ltd 7051794

FILE LOCATIONS

All original documents stored in Dropbox:

Dropbox/3 venture/auwa/admin/

└─ corporation/	– Company incorporation documents
└─ trademark/	
└─ 1 license/	
└─ _archive/	– Original (superseded) license
└─ 20260223_auwa_assignment.*	– IP Assignment: personal → Auwa Ltd
└─ 20260223_auwa_license.*	– Operating license: Auwa Ltd → More
Air Ltd	
└─ 2 word mark/	
└─ application/	
└─ batch 1/	– Original 4-class filing +
examination + advertisement	
└─ batch 2/	– Additional 3-class filing (16 Apr

2026)

			└─ exclusions/	
				└─ junno-international.txt
				└─ wipo-results.png
				└─ ownership/
				└─ 3 design mark/
				└─ application/
				└─ artwork/
				└─ evidence/
				└─ search/
				└─ costing/
				└─ domains/
				└─ office/

	– Japan conflict analysis
	– WIPO search results
	– TM16 transfer to Auwa Ltd
	– Design mark filing (16 Apr 2026)
	– Prepared character silhouettes
	– Creation date evidence (2016–2020)
	– WIPO + Google search results
	– Financial planning
	– Domain registration records
	– Virtual office details